

Content Outline / Blueprint

Discovering Your Narrative Voice — Course Architecture & Sequencing Logic

The Storyboard/Wireframe documents what's on each screen and how it behaves. This document sits one level above that: it explains why the content is sequenced in this order, how each block depends on the one before it, and where this module fits in the larger course it belongs to. Screen-level interaction decisions are out of scope here — see the Storyboard for those.

1. Course Context

"Discovering Your Narrative Voice" is Week 2 of a multi-week Creative Writing course. Week 1 is not covered by this audit. Week 3, "The Writing Process," follows directly and is referenced in the module's closing transition screen (Screen 14) but is also outside this audit's scope.

Within Week 2, the module has three content arcs, each building on the last: (1) naming the structural elements of a story, (2) defining narrative voice as a distinct concept, and (3) applying both through two hands-on activities. The sequencing is deliberate — a learner can't meaningfully practice narrative voice (arc 2-3) without first having language for what a story is made of (arc 1).

2. Sequencing Logic

Screens	Content Block	Builds On	Enables
1-2	Orientation: module intro + first video	Nothing (entry point)	Establishes topic and format expectations before content begins
3-4	Storytelling Elements (8 terms, chunked across two cards)	Screens 1-2	Gives the learner shared vocabulary needed to discuss voice and character later
5	Craft Tips (revised)	Screens 3-4	Reinforces elements just taught with actionable, practice-oriented tips rather than new content
6-7	Narrative Voice orientation + video	Screens 3-5	Introduces the module's core concept, now that the learner has vocabulary to understand it
8	Voice Switch activity	Screens 6-7	First hands-on application — lowest-stakes activity, working with someone else's story rather than the learner's own writing or personal material
9-10	Style Analysis orientation + video	Screen 8	Transitions from voice (style-level) to character (content-level) analysis
11	Character Profile activity	Screens 9-10	Second hands-on application — higher-order task than Screen 8,

Screens	Content Block	Builds On	Enables
			asking the learner to construct interiority rather than just imitate an existing voice
12	Conclusion (recap + closing reflection line)	Screens 3-11	Ties the whole arc together and bridges to real-world application
13-14	Feedback + transition to Week 3	Screen 12	Closes the loop and hands off to the next module

3. Chunking Rationale

The eight storytelling elements are deliberately split across two screens (3-4) rather than presented as one long list — consistent with the cognitive load principles in the Instructional Strategy document. The same logic applies at the course level: two activities (Screens 8 and 11) rather than one larger combined task, so the learner practices one new skill at a time instead of narrative voice and character construction simultaneously.

The two activities are also intentionally sequenced by difficulty, not just topic. Voice Switch (Screen 8) asks the learner to imitate an external voice using provided material — lower cognitive and emotional stakes. Character Profile (Screen 11) asks the learner to construct psychological depth for a character of their own choosing — a more demanding task, placed second so the learner has already had one successful hands-on rep before attempting it.

4. Estimated Pacing

Content Block	Est. Time	Pacing Note
Orientation (1-2)	2-3 min	Includes optional video; skippable per the revised video-gate fix.
Storytelling Elements (3-5)	5-7 min	Self-paced accordion; time varies by how many definitions a learner expands.
Narrative Voice intro (6-7)	2-3 min	Includes second optional video.
Voice Switch activity (8)	10-15 min	Untimed by design; writing happens on paper (personal notebook/pen), not submitted through the platform.
Style Analysis (9-11)	10-15 min	Includes third video and the character profile activity.
Conclusion + feedback (12-13)	2-3 min	Optional feedback field, no minimum.

Total estimated time: 30-45 minutes, though the module is explicitly untimed and self-paced — these are planning estimates for facility scheduling purposes, not targets communicated to the learner.

5. Dependencies Outside This Module

- Both activities (Screens 8 and 11) direct the learner to write in a personal notebook or on paper, using a pen provided in the facility — not an in-platform tool. Activities are not submitted or graded through the module; they're private, physical, offline work the learner does in their own space. This is a feature of the environment, not a gap: it keeps the writing itself untracked and un-surveilled, consistent with the trauma-informed emphasis on privacy in the Instructional Strategy document.
- Week 3 continuity: Screen 14 hands off to "The Writing Process." This outline doesn't assume anything about Week 3's content, only that the transition point exists.